

3 SPORTS AND GAMES



*A team is where a boy can prove his courage on his own.
A gang is where a coward goes to hide.*

Mickey Mantle

*The five S's of sports training are: stamina, speed, strength,
skill and spirit; but the greatest of these is spirit.*

Ken Doherty

□ VOCABULARY INPUT

Dealing with this topic you will come across the following vocabulary. Read it and look up the unknown words in your dictionary.

- ♦ **types of sports:**
 - summer and winter sports
 - outdoor and indoor sports
 - individual and collective sports
 - water sports (sailing, regatta, yachting, water-skiing, diving, synchronised swimming)
 - martial arts (karate, taekwondo, aikido, kendo...)
 - extreme sports (sky diving, hang gliding, parachuting, cliff diving, whitewater rafting, windsurfing, extreme motocross, freestyle skiing, mountain biking, skateboarding)
- ♦ **sport equipment:** puck, hockey stick, pair of skates, ball, goal, net, mat, bat, cap, racket, skis, goggles, life jacket, swimwear, paddle, canoe, running shoes, trainers (AmE: sneakers), skiing boots, skiing poles, basket, golf clubs, rings, motorcycle, pommel horse, weight plates, wooden stick, table-tennis table
- ♦ **body protection:** padding, padded gloves, padded plastic helmet, shoulder pads, hip pads, knee pads, shin pads, helmet with faceguard
- ♦ **sport fields and areas:** athletic stadium, circuit, court, golf course, gymnasium, four-walled court, grass court, hard court, ice rink, indoor pool, lake, pitch, pond, ring, ski resort, track
- ♦ **reasons for practising sports:** relaxation, increase of stamina, looking after health, weight loss, muscle building, new friendships, development of character, team building, learning to win and lose, cooperation, active body work, clear mind, extreme physical and mental exertion
- ♦ **professional sports:** problems with overtraining, doping (anabolic steroids, human growth hormones), corruption, drug testing, coping with being rich and famous
- ♦ **sport events:** matches, tournaments, competitions, Olympic Games (Olympic rings, Olympic flag, Olympic flame, Olympic creed, Olympic oath, opening ceremony, medal awarding ceremony, threat of terrorist attacks)

□ DISCUSSION QUESTIONS

Before reading the text, discuss the following questions in class.

1. What is the difference between sports and games?
2. Which sports do you like most? What do you like about them?
3. What equipment do you have at home for practising different sports?
4. What are the pros and cons of practising individual sports versus playing team games?
5. Which sports/games don't you like? Explain your reasons.
6. Which sport events do you like watching?
7. Which sports do you find extreme?
8. Would you like to try an extreme sport? Which one and why?
9. Which professional sportsmen/sportswomen do you admire?
10. What do you know about the Olympic Games?

□ TEXT

Read the texts below in silence. Check the meaning of the words in bold and answer the questions below.

REASONS FOR PLAYING SPORTS

There are a number of different reasons that people have in common that explain why they play sport. They need to relax and they know that practising a sport, suitable for them, can **improve** their health. Some sport activities, such as aerobics, jogging, swimming or bodybuilding, are preferred by those who want to **lose weight**. Many parents want their children to practise a sport. Most children do it as a hobby, but some later become professionals. Parents believe that practising a sport is a good way for their children to spend their free time and it develops their character. Many children and young people play a team sport. A lot of **competitions** are **held** both on national and international levels. When a team wins, it is a great source of motivation for the players to want to continue to improve, but it is also important to learn how to **accept defeat** when their team loses. Practising a sport makes us fit, active, goal-oriented and ambitious.

1. What are common reasons for practising sports?
2. Why do parents encourage their children to practise sports?

TYPES OF SPORTS

Sports can be generally divided into **indoor** and **outdoor sports**. **Gymnastics** is a typical indoor sport, **athletics** a typical outdoor sport. It includes **track and field events** (the marathon, **long-distance run**, **cross-country run**) and **sprinting events** (the hundred

metres, **hurdles**). Jumping and throwing (**hammer, discus, javelin, shot put**) are also athletic sports. Indoor sports can be practised all year round, but many outdoor sports, such as cycling, **hiking** and most water sports, like **sailing, regatta, water-skiing, diving, wind-surfing** and others, depend on the weather and so are mostly enjoyed during the summer. Swimming is also a typical summer sport, but it is possible to practise it all year round in **indoor pools**. In winter, sportsmen practise winter sports, such as skiing, skating, snow-boarding and **tobogganing**. Skiers can practise the **giant slalom, downhill racing, ski jumps** or **cross-country skiing** in **ski resorts** where there are good snow conditions. Skating includes **figure skating** and **speed skating**, which are practised on **skating rinks**. In winter, people like to ski in ski resorts when the snow conditions are **favourable**. Extreme sports are associated with danger, excitement and adventure that can be experienced in the air, on water and on land. For example, bungee jumping, sky diving, hang gliding and parachuting **involve** height; extreme motocross, freestyle skiing, mountain biking and skateboarding **require** speed and **spectacular stunts**; **cliff diving, whitewater rafting** and windsurfing are connected with respect for water and extreme physical and mental **exertion**.

3. What types of sports are mentioned in the text above?
4. What attracts people to do extreme sports according to the writer?

POPULAR GAMES IN BRITAIN, THE USA AND SLOVAKIA

Games are those sports in which at least two players are involved. The most popular games are football, rugby, hockey, tennis, golf, cricket, basketball, volleyball, badminton, squash and handball.

The British are sport-loving people. Some of the games, such as football, rugby, golf and tennis, **originated** in Britain and **spread all over the world** from there. The most popular game is football. The **Cup Final** is the most important football match of the year in England. It is played at *Wembley Stadium* near London, which has **seats** for 100 000 **spectators**. **Besides** team games, such as football and rugby, tennis is also very popular. Tennis can be played on a **grass court** or a **hard court**. The most famous tennis **tournament** is played at *Wimbledon* every year. The **championship** is watched by thousands of spectators and **TV viewers** all over the world.

Slovaks are good at hockey. A lot of Slovak hockey players play in *American* and *Canadian National Hockey League* teams. The American, Russian, Canadian and Swedish hockey teams **are considered** the best. The Czechoslovak hockey team was considered one of the best, but after Czechoslovakia split, the Slovak and the Czech national hockey teams **took part in** the World Cups **separately** and even **played against each other**. The Slovak team **lost** in the 2000 World Cup final against the Czech Republic. However, the Slovak team were the winners of the 2002 *Hockey World Cup*.

The most popular games in America are baseball, American football, basketball, tennis, boxing, **wrestling** and ice-hockey. There are many beautiful winter sport centres in the USA. Typical winter sports, such as skiing, skating and snow-boarding, are very popular. Tennis and squash are leading summer sports in the USA. Squash is a game for

two players played in a **four-walled court** with a special racket and a soft ball. Water sports, such as yachting, wind-surfing and surfing, are loved by many people.

5. Which games originated in Britain?
6. Which sports and games are the most popular in the USA?
7. Which Slovak hockey players' successes are mentioned in the text?

PROFESSIONAL SPORT

Professional sport is, **unfortunately**, connected with several negative **phenomena**. High competition in sport forces the **elite** sportsmen and women to be the best. This often **leads to overtraining** or doping, which has a very negative effect on their health. They take anabolic steroids or human **growth** hormones to be the best. During important competitions the sportsmen and women are tested and may easily be **disqualified**. This may **have** a negative **impact on** their career. Success in professional sport is nowadays connected with money and popularity. Some of the top sportsmen and women find it difficult to **cope with** being rich and famous.

8. Name some negative phenomena of professional sport mentioned in the text above.

OLYMPIC GAMES

Two of the most important **sport events** are the *Summer* and *Winter Olympic Games* which are held every four years in a different country. It first took place in **ancient Greece**. Only men could compete and they were naked and **barefoot**. The spectators watched them from the hills outside the stadium. In 392 A.D., they were **abolished** as a **pagan** ritual. *Pierre de Coubertin* **revived** the idea of the Olympic Games and became the **founder** of the modern Olympic Games. The Olympic Rings are a **well-known** symbol of the Olympic Games. They represent the **unity** of the five continents. They **appear** in five colours on the Olympic Flag. The first part of the Olympic **creed** "*The most important thing in the Olympic Games is not to win but to take part...*" is often used for all kinds of other competitions. Only the best sportsmen and women of each country are chosen to take part in the Olympic Games. For them it is a great **honour** to represent their country. People all over the world pay a lot of attention to these sports events and that is why the Olympic Games **are** often **under the threat of terrorist attacks**. **Therefore**, the countries which organise the games try to **ensure** maximum security for everybody involved in the games.

(Adapted from http://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Olympic_Games)

9. Where did the Olympic Games originate and what is their symbol?
10. What do you think about the creed of the Olympic Games?

□ VOCABULARY LIST

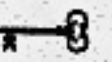
to abolish – zrušiť
athletics [æθletiks] – atletika
ancient Greece [eɪnfənt] – staroveké Grécko
to appear [ə'piə] – objaviť sa
barefoot [bɜːfʊt] – bosý
besides – okrem
championship – majstrovstvá
cliff diving – skákanie z útesu
competition – súťaž
to cope with – vyrovnáť sa s
creed [kriːd] – motto, krédo
cross-country run – cezpoľný beh
cross-country skiing – lyžovanie na bežkách
the Cup Final – finálový zápas (vo futbale)
discus – disk
disqualified – diskvalifikovaný
diving [daɪvɪŋ] – potápanie
downhill racing – zjazd na lyžiach
elite [ɪliːt] – elitný, vybraný
to ensure – zabezpečiť, zaistiť
exertion [ɪgzɜːʃən] – námaha
favourable – priaznivé
figure skating – krasokorčuľovanie
founder – zakladateľ
four-walled court – kurt so štyrmi stenami
giant slalom [dʒaɪənt slaɪləm] – obrý slalom na lyžiach
grass court [kɔːt] – trávnatý kurt
growth – rast
gymnastics [dʒɪmnæstiks] – gymnastika
hammer – kladivo
hard court – tenisový kurt s tvrdým povrchom
hiking [haɪkɪŋ] – pešia turistika
to hold – usporiadať, organizovať
honour [ˈɒnər] (AmE: honor) – pocta, česť
hurdles [hɜːdəs] – beh cez prekážky
to improve – zlepšiť
indoor pool – krytý bazén
indoor sport – halový šport
to involve – zahŕňať
javelin [dʒævəlɪn] – hod oštepom
long-distance run – beh na dlhé trate
to lose [luːz] – prehrať
to originate – vzniknúť

outdoor sport – šport praktizovaný vonku
pagan [peɪɡən] – pohanský
phenomenon [fə'nɒmɪnən] (pl. phenomena) – jav
regatta [rɪgætə] – veslárske preteky
to require [rɪkwaɪə] – vyžadovať
to revive [rɪ'vaɪv] – obnoviť, oživiť
sailing – plachtenie
seat – miesto na sedenie
separately – zvlášť
shot put – vrh guľou
skating rink – umelé klzisko
ski resort – lyžiarske stredisko
spectacular stunt [spek'tækjələ stʌnt] – efektný (veľkolepý) kaskadérsky kúsok
spectator [spekteɪtə] – divák
speed skating – rýchlokorčuľovanie
sport event – športová udalosť
sprinting events – preteky na krátku vzdialenosť
therefore – (a) preto
to take part in – zúčastniť sa
tobogganing [təbɒɡənɪŋ] – sánkovanie
tournament – turnaj
track and field events – atletické disciplíny
TV viewer [vjuːə] – televízny divák
unfortunately – nanešťastie
unity – jednota, súdržnosť
well-known – dobre známy
whitewater rafting – splavovanie divokej rieky
wrestling – zápasenie

to accept defeat – prijať porážku
to have an impact on – mať dopad na niečo
to lead to overtraining – viesť k nadmernému trénovaniu
to lose weight – schudnúť
to play against each other – hrať jeden proti druhému
to spread all over the world – rozšíriť sa do celého sveta
under the threat of terrorist attacks [θret] – pod hrozbou teroristických útokov

□ VOCABULARY PRACTICE

Task 1 Which sports and games can be practised in these places?



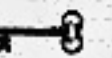
Example: on a golf course – *golf*

- | | |
|----------------------|---------------------------|
| a) on an ice rink | f) in a four-walled court |
| b) on a court | g) on a pitch |
| c) in a gymnasium | h) in a ring |
| d) in an indoor pool | i) on a lake/pond |
| e) in a ski resort | j) on a track/circuit |

Task 2 What equipment do you need to practise the sports from the previous exercise? Choose from the box.

life jacket – puck – goggles – hockey stick – racket – padded gear – ball – helmet – paddle – running shoes – canoe – mat – padded gloves – basket – rings – net goal – motorcycle – swimwear – pommel horse – cap – bat – skis – golf club – pair of skates – weight plates

Task 3 Which are the three most important qualities of a good sportsman/sportswoman? Form nouns from the adjectives below.



- a) physically strong b) healthy c) competitive d) fair e) responsible
 f) famous g) recognised h) hard-working i) intelligent
 j) creative k) selfish l) successful m) careful n) ambitious
 o) friendly p) modest r) courageous

Task 4 What are the common reasons for practising sports or doing them as a career?**Discuss the following issues in small groups. Rank them according to their importance:****UNIMPORTANT – IMPORTANT – VERY IMPORTANT**

- | | |
|--|--|
| <ul style="list-style-type: none">a) they increase staminab) they keep us fitc) they keep us in shaped) they help us lose weight and build musclee) they teach us how to be part of a teamf) they help us find new friendsg) they prevent some diseasesh) they can improve our health | <ul style="list-style-type: none">i) they are a good way of relaxingj) they help us learn to accept defeatk) they are a good way of spending free timel) they teach us how to deal with popularitym) they make us more goal-oriented and ambitiousn) they make our body more flexible and activeo) they increase our self-confidence |
|--|--|